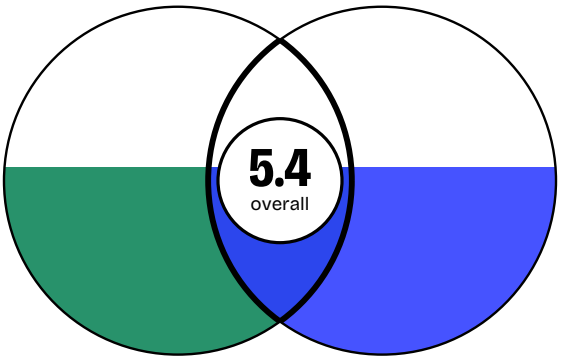
Evaluation sheet

CropLink

Prepared for Ayesha Raza | Stage: Have notes & started researching | 24 October 2026



Pakistan 5.4 **Global 5.4**

Needs validation: Validate further before building

The business model relies heavily on logistics and farmer adoption, which remain untested. Further validation with small-scale pilots and logistics partnerships is necessary before expanding.

The idea

CropLink is a WhatsApp-based marketplace connecting small farmers directly to urban grocery buyers in Punjab, eliminating middlemen to increase farmers' revenue and provide fresher produce to stores.

Pakistan 5.4/10 Needs validation

CropLink addresses a significant pain point for small farmers, but faces challenges with trust and logistics. The current infrastructure may support adoption in urban areas, but farmers' traditional loyalties pose a risk.

Global 5.4/10 Needs validation

Globally, bypassing agricultural middlemen is appealing, yet CropLink needs stronger differentiation and scalable logistics to compete internationally.

Biggest strength

Addresses a significant issue of crop value loss for small farmers in Punjab.

Biggest risk

Overcoming farmers' ingrained trust in traditional middlemen (arthis).

Priority actions

1. Conduct pilot with a small group of farmers and grocers to test assumptions.
2. Develop partnerships with logistics companies to ensure reliable delivery.
3. Engage directly with farmers to understand trust issues and build credibility.
4. Research and document successful models in similar global markets.
5. Clarify unit economics and ensure model sustainability before scaling.

Pakistan market: 5.4/10, Needs validation

#	Criterion	Score	Why
1	**Market Demand & Problem Severity**	7/10	High crop value loss is a tangible problem. Demand likely with proper execution.
2	**Total Addressable Market & Reachable Demand**	6/10	Limited initial geographic focus in Lahore/Multan constrains addressable market.
3	**Purchasing Power & Willingness to Pay**	5/10	Farmers might resist price if mistrust persists; grocers have cost-saving incentive.
4	**Revenue Model & Local Unit Economics**	4/10	Uncertain logistics costs and transaction frequency impact unit economics.
5	**Competition & Existing Alternatives**	5/10	Existing platforms like Tazah; WhatsApp model offers slight differentiation.
6	**Digital & Physical Infrastructure Readiness**	6/10	Smartphone and WhatsApp penetration good, logistics infrastructure uncertain.
7	**Regulatory, Legal & Tax Feasibility**	7/10	Agricultural markets have standard regulations; WhatsApp channel limits issues.
8	**Supply Chain & Operational Feasibility**	4/10	Logistics partner uncertainty and cool-chain needs present significant hurdles.
9	**Trust, Adoption & Customer Behavior**	5/10	Farmer loyalty to arthi; younger founder needs to build trust.
10	**Scalability, Resilience & Local Execution**	5/10	Scalability limited without solving delivery logistics and farmer adoption issues.

Global market: 5.4/10, Needs validation

#	Criterion	Score	Why
1	**Global Market Size & Growth Potential**	6/10	Large market for farm-direct sales; growth in digital solutions for agriculture.
2	**Global Problem-Solution Fit**	6/10	Global issue of middlemen in agriculture; WhatsApp accessibility is a benefit.
3	**Competitive Advantage & Defensibility**	4/10	WhatsApp-centric model easy to replicate; lacks strong barrier for global players.
4	**Global Business Model & Profitability**	5/10	Profitability unclear; competitive price pressure high internationally.
5	**Scalability & Replicability**	6/10	WhatsApp infrastructure aids replication; logistics is a major challenge.
6	**International Regulatory & Legal Compatibility**	7/10	Generally compliant; WhatsApp usage simplified but faces data privacy challenges abroad.
7	**Localization & Cross-Cultural Fit**	5/10	Requires language and local adaptation; cultural practices vary by region.
8	**Customer Acquisition & Distribution Potential**	5/10	Customer acquisition through WhatsApp needs affordable strategies and reliable logistics partners.
9	**Capital Requirements & Funding Attractiveness**	5/10	High logistics costs expected; competitive funding market, but strong farm tech interest.
10	**Market Entry Risk & Long-Term Resilience**	5/10	International logistics reliability and trust barriers present high risks.

How to read this sheet. An AI agent scored each criterion from 1 to 10 using the FoundersLens evaluation framework (ten criteria for Pakistan, ten for the global market). A market score is the average of its ten criteria and the overall score is the average of the two market scores. Bands: 8 and above Strong, 6.5 to 7.9 Promising, 5 to 6.4 Needs validation, 3.5 to 4.9 High risk, below 3.5 Weak. Scores are directional judgements, not verified market data.